SANA ESSENCIA · A FREE CARD FOR STRESS AWARENESS WEEK

5 questions to plan the year-end workload with your team

Based on the 'Demands' area of HSE's Management Standards, which covers issues such as workload, work patterns and the work environment.

How to use it

The run-up to the year-end break can get busy. Bring these five questions to your next team meeting and work through them together. Listen first, then agree what you'll do. They're here to help you plan the steps with your team, not to score anyone.

1. **What's already promised between now and the break, and does it fit inside the hours we've agreed to work?**
   List the fixed dates first, then the work that leads up to each one.
2. **Who's away over the coming weeks, and who picks up what while they're gone?**
   Include part-time patterns, booked leave and anyone working different hours in December.
3. **Is each big piece of work with someone who has the skills and the time for it?**
   Spot anything that needs a handover, a quick bit of training or a second pair of hands, and sort it now rather than in the last week.
4. **Does anything about our work patterns or our workspace need sorting before the busy weeks?**
   Think about rotas, travel, early starts and late finishes, shared desks, noise or a cold room.
5. **If someone's workload stops fitting, how will they tell us, and how quickly will we respond?**
   Agree the route now, so nobody has to wait for the next meeting to say so.

Before you finish

Write down what you agreed, who is doing each step and the date you'll look at it again, ideally in the first week back. Share the note with the team so everyone sees the same plan.

Want to go further? The Manager's Pack takes you through all six areas, with team conversation cards and an editable action plan. See sanaessencia.co.uk

General guidance, not legal advice. This card helps you plan the steps with your team. It isn't a risk assessment and doesn't replace your own assessment or advice from a competent health and safety professional. HSE's guidance on work-related stress: hse.gov.uk/stress

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